

FIGS *Ficus carica*

Although they look and taste exotic, figs are relatively easy to grow and will provide you with a good yearly crop as long as you contain their roots, give them plenty of sun and warmth, and keep them watered. Figs are available year-round and can be planted any time from early fall, so why not build yourself a fig pit and train your fig tree into an attractive fan shape against a south-facing wall?

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Figs need a warm, sheltered site and should be located carefully, away from strong winds and frost pockets. Preferably, grow them against a south-facing wall, or grow under cover in a greenhouse. Figs will grow happily in a fig pit (see right) or in containers, and, as long as the pot is not too heavy, you may be able to alter your tree's location as the seasons change.

Figs prefer alkaline conditions, although they will grow happily in most well-drained soils; if the soil is too rich, figs may grow too rapidly, producing plenty of foliage but few fruits. If growing against a wall, you will need to provide supports for your fig tree—fix horizontal wires every 12 in (30 cm).



New leaves will burst forth in spring.

CROP CARE

Fig trees need to be watered regularly, especially if they are growing in a pot; letting them dry out encourages them to drop their fruits. Pot-grown and pit-grown trees will need to be fed with a balanced fertilizer every year, and all figs benefit from a compost mulch in early spring. Pot-grown fig trees may need to be repotted every few years. In colder regions,